▼ GLASSHOUSE



REPORTING RIDDLE

Priyanka Gandhi Vadra's appointment as Assam screening committee chairperson for the coming assembly poll has exposed an unusual hierarchical knot within the Congress. Going by the organisational protocol, the screening panel works with the Pradesh Congress Committee to finalise candidate lists, reports to the AICC state in-charge, who in turn accedes to the AICC general secretary (organisation). In Assam, this places Priyanka working alongside **Gaurav Gogoi,** jointly reporting to **Jitendra Singh,** who then reports to **K.C. Venugopal.** Muddling matters further, they will all be monitored by 'senior observers' Bhupesh Baghel and D.K. Shivakumar. Within the party, this has triggered some unease: will a Gandhi family member adhere to this chain of command? Or maybe this is a way to insulate her from criticism in the eventuality that the Congress fails to fire.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ BROKEN LAUNDROMAT

TURNCOATS IN TROUBLE

Two high-profile politicians who defected to the BJP ahead of the 2024 general election are now under the Rajasthan anti-corruption bureau (ACB) scanner. Mahendrajeet Singh Malviya, a tribal leader who quit the Congress and his assembly seat to contest the Lok Sabha polls on a BJP ticket, only to lose, saw his offices searched



soon after signalling a return to his old party. Meanwhile, the ACB has also registered a case in the mid-day meal scam case, where another ex-Congress minister and turncoat, Rajendra Yadav, had been raided by the ED earlier. So, is this a dual strategy: CM **Bhajan Lal Sharma** using the investigative agencies to pressure defectors while also blunting the 'washing machine' tag the BJP is saddled with vis-à-vis turncoats?